

DESIGN CODE NS 05

LITTLE DUCK

Plushie

BLACK + WHITE · WHITE BACKGROUNDS · PROGRESS BOXES

EMBROIDERED EYES · CONFIDENT BEGINNER · 1.5–2 HOURS · ABOUT 16 CM

CHENILLE #6 · 4.5 MM HOOK

NAMED ORIGINAL COLOURWAY

SUNSHINE YELLOW · TANGERINE · BLACK

ABOUT THIS COMPANION FILE

Designed for economical home printing and progress tracking.

Large artwork is omitted; the written directions match the full-colour edition.

Pattern profile

NS 05 is the permanent identity of this pattern. Keep it with every revision, tester note, photograph and support message.

FORMAT EMBROIDERED EYES	SKILL LEVEL CONFIDENT BEGINNER	ACTIVE TIME 1.5-2 HOURS	FINISHED SIZE ABOUT 16 CM
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Named original colourway

SUNSHINE YELLOW body + wings · about 25-35 g	TANGERINE flat beak · small amount	BLACK embroidered eyes
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Use the written colour names and material roles when selecting yarn; screen and printer appearance varies.

Progress tracking

Every construction-table row begins with a printable [] box. Tick it only after completing the row and confirming the stated count.

Read before making

Read every component and finishing note before beginning. Mark completed rows, confirm the count at each row end, and stop immediately if your count differs. Complete internal eyes, embroidery, knots and joins while the relevant opening remains accessible.

Safety: this PDF does not claim that a finished item meets any toy or consumer-product standard. Follow the full Safety section and obtain every assessment required for the finished item's intended market and use.

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How to use this pattern

Read the complete component before beginning it. Move the marker at the start of every crochet round unless the master says otherwise. Diagrams and illustrations support orientation only; the numbered written directions control construction.

Embroidered eyes · Confident beginner · 1.5 - 2 hours — Design Code NS 05

A round, squashy duckling in fluffy chenille, worked as a single piece from tail to crown - no body-to-head seam. Only the wings and the beak are sewn on.

FINISHED SIZE About 16 cm (6.25 in) tall and 7.5 cm (3 in) wide in super-bulky chenille (#6) on a 4.5 mm hook. One seamless body; 2 wings + 1 beak to sew.

Safety — read this first

This duck uses embroidered eyes and no plastic eye components, removing that particular detachment hazard. This alone does not establish age suitability or product compliance. If you supply finished ducks, determine all classification, assessment, testing, documentation, labelling and traceability duties for intended and reasonably foreseeable use in each destination market. Do not claim compliance without supporting records. Check every seam and surrounding stitch by hand and confirm that the chosen chenille pile does not shed; these workshop checks do not replace any prescribed test.

Materials

- Body yarn: super-bulky chenille (#6), yellow, about 25-35 g. A 100 g ball makes two ducks comfortably. Fluffy chenille is the whole look.
- Details: a small amount of matching super-bulky (#6) orange yarn for the beak; black embroidery floss for the eyes. The stated beak size assumes the orange yarn matches the body gauge.
- Hook: 4.5 mm (US 7).
- Stuffing & notions: fibre fill about 25-35 g packed firmly; yarn needle, stitch marker, pins.

Gauge & size

Gauge: about 8 mm per stitch and 7 mm per round in super-bulky chenille. Chenille varies between brands, so measure a 12-stitch swatch (about 10 cm) first. Finished size: about 16 cm tall and 7.5 cm wide - 23 rounds at 7 mm and a widest point of 30 stitches at 8 mm.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR - magic ring · ch - chain

sc - single crochet · inc - increase (2 sc in one st)

dec - invisible decrease · sl st - slip stitch

FLO - front loops only · FO - fasten off

st(s) - stitch(es) · Rnd(s) - round(s) · (n) - stitch count at round end

Work in a continuous spiral - no join, no chain 1 between rounds - with a marker in the first stitch of every round.

Techniques used, in the order you will meet them

1. Magic ring & spiral - The start of the body and each wing is a magic ring. Work in a continuous spiral - no join, no chain 1 between rounds - with a marker in the first stitch of every round.
2. Invisible decrease - Insert the hook under the FRONT loop only of each of the next two stitches (three loops are now on the hook). Yarn over and pull through the two front loops, then yarn over and pull through the two remaining loops. This is flatter than a standard decrease, which matters at this scale.
3. Around a chain (the beak) - The beak is worked around both sides of a starting chain: along one side, three stitches in the far end chain, then back along the opposite side and two more stitches in the first working chain. With ch 5, the chain nearest the hook is skipped as the turning chain; all FOUR remaining chains are used. Rnd 1 has 10 stitches and Rnd 2 increases evenly to 16.
4. Through both layers - To close each flat wing, fold it and single-crochet across both layers at once - 6 sc take the 12 stitches down to 6 and leave a flat half-disc.
5. Embroidery & sewing - The eyes are embroidered (no safety eyes). The wings and the flattened, unstuffed beak are sewn on; catch whole stitches, make a second seam pass and pull-test each attachment.

Instructions

1. Body - yellow chenille

Preparation: make both wings (section 2) and the beak (section 3) before starting the body. You will attach the wings at the Rnd-9 pause and the beak at the Rnd-19 pause; neither pause should be spent crocheting a missing component.

The waist at R10-R12 and the reflare at R13-R14 separate body from head with no seam. Body and head are the same diameter (30 stitches, about 76 mm); the 18-stitch waist reads as the neck. Start stuffing at R10 - once the waist closes you cannot reach the body.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
[] R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
[] R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
[] R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
[] R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
[] R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	body full width
[] R6	sc in each st around	(30)	wings attach R6 - R9
[] R7	sc in each st around	(30)	-
[] R8	sc in each st around	(30)	-
[] R9	sc in each st around	(30)	PAUSE: attach both wings before stuffing
[] R10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	START STUFFING NOW
[] R11	sc in each st around	(24)	-
[] R12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	waist closing
[] R13	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
[] R14	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	head begins
[] R15	sc in each st around	(30)	-
[] R16	sc in each st around	(30)	eyes at R16 - R17

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
[] R17	sc in each st around	(30)	-
[] R18	sc in each st around	(30)	beak across R16 - R18
[] R19	sc in each st around	(30)	PAUSE: embroider eyes and attach beak before R20
[] R20	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	-
[] R21	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	stuff head, shape cheeks
[] R22	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	add final stuffing
[] R23	dec x 6	(6)	close via FLO

Immediately after Rnd 9, sew on both wings while the body is empty and the 30-stitch opening lets you knot their tails inside; make a second seam pass. Then begin stuffing with Rnd 10 and continue through Rnd 19. Pause again before the head opening narrows: embroider and knot the eyes inside, then sew on the beak with its tail secured inside. Only then work Rnds 20-23, adding the final stuffing as directed. FO with a long tail; thread through the FLO of the 6 remaining stitches, pull tight, knot and bury.

Smaller head option: skip the R14 flare (keep R14-R19 at 24) and close with R20 [2 sc, dec] x 6 (18), R21 [sc, dec] x 6 (12), R22 dec x 6 (6).

2. Wings - yellow chenille (make 2)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
[] R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
[] R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
[] R3	sc in each st around	(12)	-
[] R4	sc in each st around	(12)	flatten, sc 6 across both layers

Do not stuff. Flatten and sc 6 across both layers to close (12 sts to 6), leaving a flat half-disc about 30 mm across. Sew to the sides spanning R6-R9, angled slightly back.

3. Beak - orange (make 1, worked around a chain)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
[] Found.	ch 5	-	-
[] Rnd 1	sc in 2nd ch from hook, sc in next 2 ch, 3 sc in last ch; rotate to work along the opposite side: sc in next 2 ch, 2 sc in the remaining loop of the first working ch	(10)	uses all 4 working chains
[] Rnd 2	inc, 2 sc, inc x 3, 2 sc, inc x 2	(16)	10 anchors used; 6 increases

Sl st to the first stitch and FO with a long tail. Do NOT stuff - flatten it to a flat lens. As written it is a bold ~50 mm cartoon beak; for a daintier duck work Rnd 1 only (10 sts, about 35-38 mm).

Finishing & assembly

Face & assembly - work in this order:

1. Wings: immediately after Rnd 9 and before stuffing, sew one wing to each side over Rnds 6-9, angled slightly back. Make a second seam pass, knot the tails inside and pull-test both wings.
2. Stuff from Rnd 10: fill the body firmly as the waist begins to close - the neck narrows fast. Continue through Rnd 19, then pause again.
3. Eyes: immediately after Rnd 19, embroider black eyes between Rnds 16 and 17, about 7 stitches apart (roughly 56 mm along the stitch line on the approximately 76 mm-diameter head). Knot the floss ends inside while the 30-stitch opening is clear.
4. Beak: still before Rnd 20, pin horizontally across Rnds 16-18, centred between the eyes, and sew around the outer edge; knot and bury the tail inside.
5. Close: resume at Rnd 20, top up stuffing through Rnd 22, then work Rnd 23, close via the FLO and bury the end.

The flat orange beak and embroidered eyes avoid plastic facial parts; all sewn attachments still require secure seams and pull-testing.

Troubleshooting

- Much taller than 16 cm. Your chenille is thicker than gauge. A 12-stitch swatch at 10 mm per stitch finishes near 20 cm.
- Much shorter. Finer yarn - see the size table; DK on 3.0 mm gives 7-8 cm, not 10-12.
- Wings sit on the neck. Too high. R6-R9 is the body; R10-R12 is the waist.
- Beak leaves a gap / puffs. Ch 5 gives four working chains after the skipped turning chain. Rnd 1 must use all four on both sides and finish at 10 stitches. Do not stuff; flatten before pinning.
- Stuffing shows / head flops. Hook too large for the yarn, or the waist was under-packed. Pack R10-R12 firmly before the reflare.
- Cannot reach the body to stuff. You started too late - begin at R10 while the waist is still 24 stitches wide.

Making a smaller duck

Yarn / starting hook	Target finished height
Velvet / bulky (#5) - 3.0 mm	10 - 12 cm
Aran / worsted (#4) - 2.75-3.0 mm	9 - 10 cm
DK / light worsted (#3) - 2.5-2.75 mm	7.5 - 8.5 cm

These hooks are starting points only. Make a dense swatch and measure a completed sample before advertising any alternate size.

Colourways

SUNSHINE YELLOW body + wings · about 25–35 g	TANGERINE flat beak · small amount	BLACK embroidered eyes
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NAMED ORIGINAL COLOURWAY · SUNSHINE YELLOW · TANGERINE · BLACK.

Colourway notes: Original colourway: sunshine-yellow body and wings, tangerine-orange beak, and black embroidered eyes. Optional body-tone variations: buttercream, soft white, pale peach or duck-egg blue; keep the beak visibly contrasting and embroider the face in a dark washable thread.

Care

Follow the actual yarn label and wash-test a finished sample before publishing care claims. Until that test is complete, recommend gentle surface cleaning with a damp cloth and mild soap, followed by drying flat away from heat. Restore the pile gently by hand; brushing can pull fibres from some chenille yarns.

Terms of Use

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Safety reminder

Eyes are embroidered and there are no plastic eye components. Finished items must still meet every product-safety, testing, documentation and labelling duty applicable to their classification and market. Do not claim EN 71, CE, UKCA, CPSIA or ASTM F963 compliance without the required evidence. Secure every seam and verify that the selected chenille does not shed.

Finish checklist & notes

- [] Every row count checked before moving on
- [] Gauge, dimensions and selected version confirmed
- [] Face and internal ends completed before closure
- [] Components counted and pinned before attachment
- [] Structural seams and hanging points checked twice
- [] All yarn ends, knots and attachments inspected

PROJECT NOTES

[illegible]